Specification of the controlled designation of origin “CHÂTEAUNEUF-DU-PAPE”

approved by decree no. 2011-1567 of 16 November 2011, JORF of 19 November 2011

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin “Châteauneuf-du-Pape”, initially recognised by the decree of 15 May 1936.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No specific provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin “Châteauneuf-du-Pape” is reserved for still white and red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification and the elaboration of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Vaucluse department: Bédarrides, Châteauneuf-du-Pape, Courthézon, Orange, Sorgues.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the parcel production area whose limits were drawn on the 1/50,000 ordnance map annexed to the judgment of the Avignon court dated 28 March 1930 and by the successive modifications as approved by the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification and the elaboration of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

Ardèche department: Bourg-Saint-Andéol, Sarras, Saint-Jean-de-Muzols

Drôme department: Châteauneuf-sur-Isère, La Roche-de-Glun, Les Granges-Gontardes, Mercurol, Tain-l’Hermitage, Tulette

Gard department: Bagnols-sur-Cèze, Cavillargues, Chusclan, Codolet, Connaux, Gaujac, La Roque-sur-Cèze, Laudun, Le Pin, Lirac, Orsan, Roquemaure, Sabran, Sauveterre, Saint-Etienne-des- Sorts, Saint-Géniès-de-Comolas, Saint-Gervais, Saint-Laurent-des-Arbres, Saint-Michel-d’Euzet, Saint-Nazaire, Saint-Paul-les-Fonts, Saint-Pons-la-Calm, Saint-Victor-la-Coste, Saze, Tavel, Tresques, Vénéjean

Rhône department: Ampuis ; 2/11

Vaucluse department: Avignon, Beaumes-de-Venise, Bollène, Buisson, Caderousse, Cairanne, Camaret-sur-Aigues, Châteauneuf-de-Gadagne, Entrechaux, Faucon, Gigondas, Jonquerettes, Jonquières, Lafare, Lagarde-Paréol, Mondragon, Morières-lès-Avignon, Mornas, Piolenc, Puymeras, Rasteau, Roaix, La Roque-Alric, Sablet, Saint-Marcellin-lès-Vaison, Saint-Romain-en-Viennois, Saint-Roman-de-Malegarde, Saint-Saturnin-lès-Avignon, Sainte-Cécile-les-Vignes, Sarrians, Séguret, Sérignan-du-Comtat, Suzette, Travaillan, Uchaux, Vacqueyras, Vaison-la-Romaine, Vedène, Villedieu, Violès

V. – Grape varieties

The red and white wines come from the following varieties: bourboulenc B, brun argenté N (locally called “vaccarèse”), cinsaut N, clairette B, clairette rose Rs, counoise N, grenache blanc B, grenache gris G, grenache N, mourvèdre N, muscardin N, picardan B, piquepoul blanc B, piquepoul gris G, piquepoul noir N, roussanne B, syrah N, terret noir N.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.

PLANTING METHOD	RULES
Planting known as “au carré” (square)	- Each plant has a maximum area of 4 square metres; - This area is obtained by multiplying the inter-row and inter-plant distances; - The spacing between rows and the spacing between plants within the same row may not be greater than 2 metres.
Planting in lines	- The vines present a minimum planting density of 3,000 plants per hectare; - The spacing between rows may not be greater than 2.50 metres; - The spacing between plants within the same row may not be greater than 1.50 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.

GENERAL PROVISIONS	
Vines less than 40 years old (40th leaf)	The vines are pruned with a maximum of 12 free eyes (buds) per plant
Vines more than 40 years old (41st leaf)	The vines are pruned with a maximum of 15 free eyes per plant
PARTICULAR PROVISIONS	
VARIETIES	**RULES**
grenache noir N, mourvèdre N, piquepoul noir N, terret noir N	The vines are trained in goblet and short-pruned with spurs with a maximum of 2 free eyes per spur
bourboulenc B, brun argenté N (locally called “vaccarèse”), cinsaut N, clairette B, clairette rose Rs, counoise N, grenache blanc B, grenache gris G, muscardin N, picardan B, piquepoul blanc B, piquepoul gris G, roussanne B	The vines are trained in goblet or Royat cordon and short-pruned with spurs with a maximum of 2 free eyes per spur
syrah N	The vines are: a) – either trained in goblet or Royat cordon and short-pruned with spurs with a maximum of 2 free eyes per spur; b) – or pruned by single Guyot with a maximum of 8 free eyes on the long cane and a recall spur bearing a maximum of 2 free eyes

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.

- For vines trained in Royat cordon or pruned by single Guyot, the plants are trellised with at least two superposed wires; - The carrier wire is not situated at a height greater than 0.60 metre above the ground at the time of entry into production; - The length of the shoots, after topping, may not be less than 0.80 metre.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.

- The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 6,000 kilograms per hectare. - Where irrigation is authorised, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 4,500 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 15 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are maintained so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition.

2° – Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir:

a) – Any substantial modification of the morphology of the relief and of the natural pedological sequence of the parcels intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin is prohibited. The reworkings and development works not entailing a substantial modification of the morphology of the relief and of the natural pedological sequence of a parcel remain possible in compliance with the conditions defined at point 5 of Chapter II of the present specification;

b) – The addition of exogenous soil onto parcels of the delimited parcel area is prohibited; “exogenous soil” means a soil that does not come from the delimited parcel area;

c) – Plastic mulching is prohibited.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation may be authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code. However: - The voluntary submersion of the vines is prohibited; - The irrigation installations situated inside the vine parcels may in no case be used for the supply, to the plant, of fertilising products.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

b) – Particular harvesting provisions. - The grapes are harvested manually. Recourse to the harvesting machine is prohibited. - The qualitative sorting of the harvest is compulsory. It is carried out either in the vineyard or in the cellar. Sorting is defined as the elimination or separation of the bunches of grapes or berries that are altered (botrytis, powdery mildew, etc.) or of the insufficiently ripe bunches of grapes and berries.

c) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest. The harvest is transported under conditions making it possible to maintain its qualitative potential. These transport conditions may be the subject of a classification of the operators according to the arrangements defined in the control or inspection plan.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes. Grapes presenting a sugar content lower than the following may not be considered as being at proper ripeness: - 216 grams per litre of must for the grenache N variety; - 207 grams per litre of must for the other black varieties; - 196 grams per litre of must for the white varieties.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume. The wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 12.5 %.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 35 hectolitres per hectare. In the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July, the 1st year following that of a grafting in place, or the 1st year of a top-grafting, the yield of the young vines is limited to 35 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 35 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Loss of the benefit of the controlled designation of origin

The wines are obtained within the limit of a yield of 36 hectolitres per hectare, or of 42 hectolitres per hectare in the event of elaboration of “râpé”. This yield corresponds to the total production of the claimed parcels. Any exceeding of this yield causes the whole of the harvest to lose the benefit of the controlled designation of origin.

4° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 3rd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation.

5° – Particular provisions

The bunches of grapes or the berries arising from the qualitative sorting are: - either eliminated; - or used for the elaboration of “râpé”, a wine which may not benefit from any geographical indication. The minimum percentage of “râpé” is greater than or equal to 2 % of the claimed volumes.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Malolactic fermentation. For the red wines, the malic acid content is lower than 0.4 gram per litre at the packaging stage.

b) – Analytical standards. At the packaging stage or the bulk-transaction stage: - The wines present a content of fermentable sugars (glucose + fructose) less than or equal to 3 grams per litre, if the natural alcoholic strength by volume is lower than 14 %, and less than or equal to 4 grams per litre, if the natural alcoholic strength by volume is greater than or equal to 14 %; - The red wines present a volatile acidity less than or equal to 18.37 milliequivalents per litre and a modified colour intensity greater than or equal to 4.

c) – Oenological practices and physical treatments. - The use of pieces of wood is prohibited; - The red wines are not the subject of any enrichment; - Any thermal treatment with a view to the microbiological stabilisation of the musts and wines (packaged or non-packaged) involving a temperature greater than 40 °C is prohibited, with the exception of the flash pasteurisation of the wines (packaged or non-packaged); - The white wines do not exceed, after enrichment, a total alcoholic strength by volume of 14.5 %.

d) – Vat capacity. Every operator has an overall vat capacity greater than or equal to 1.5 times the product of the yield referred to at 1° of point VIII by the area in production vinified at the cellar.

e) – Overall upkeep of the cellar and equipment. The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) – For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before packaging. The analysis reports are kept for a period of at least 6 months from the date of packaging.

b) – The containers for volumes less than 3 litres are of glass.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates one or more storage places for the packaged wines.

4° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

The wines are placed on the market for the consumer according to the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

Set within the Rhône corridor, the geographical area of the controlled designation of origin "Châteauneuf-du-Pape" is situated on the left bank of the Rhône, about fifteen kilometres to the north of the commune of Avignon, to the west of the plain of the Comtat Venaissin.

At the heart of the sedimentary basin that constitutes the Rhône Valley, the geographical area is principally marked by the base of marine molasse deposits of the Miocene resting, to the west, on the important formations of massive Urgonian limestones, forming a plateau at around one hundred metres of altitude, and by its covering of coarse Rhône alluvium, deposited on this plateau at the end of the Pliocene. These "Villafranchian Terraces", emblematic of "Châteauneuf-du-Pape", are made up of rolled pebbles of Alpine provenance, frequently of large size and often over great thicknesses. The result is more or less deep, stony soils with numerous rolled pebbles mixed with a reddish clayey matrix. The molasses deposited successively by the incursions of the Miocene and Pliocene seas outcrop in the north-eastern sector, revealing soils of sandy texture, "safres", and the russet sandstones of the Comtat.

The landscape is thus set on a relief of terraces and slopes, sculpted by the alternation of episodes of erosion and episodes of alluviation. It is dominated by the cultivation of the vine.

The Mediterranean climate is under the influence of the Mistral, a cold and dry wind coming from the North, favouring sunshine and reducing rainfall (less than 650 millimetres per year). This sector is one of the driest of the Rhône Valley, with strong sunshine of about 2,800 hours per year, notably during the summer period, favourable to the ripeness of the berries.

The geographical area thus covers the territory of 5 communes of the Vaucluse department: Bédarrides, Châteauneuf-du-Pape, Courthézon, Orange and Sorgues.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The origin of the vineyard doubtless goes back at least to the 11th century. The cultivation of the vine develops, however, from the 14th century, with the installation of the Holy See at Avignon, and notably under the reign of JOHN XXII (1316–1334). The estate comes directly under the authority of the pope. JOHN XXII has the castle built there, his "secondary residence", of which the vestiges still remain. He contributes in an important way to the rise of the vineyard and to the renown of its wines.

The cultivation of the vine again spreads in an important way in the 18th century, under the effect of the rapid development of the wine trade. In 1750, the correspondence of the TULLE de VILLEFRANCHE family, owner of a vineyard, tells us that its production of some forty hectolitres is dispatched throughout France, to Italy, to Germany, to England, and even to the United States, thanks to a network of resellers. At the end of the 18th century, numerous buyers come from Avignon, Orange, Carpentras, Lyon, etc. The casks are dispatched from the ports of Roquemaure and Les Armeniers, for the whole of France.

In 1817, with the agreement of the Prefect, the producers decide to protect the reputation of their harvest and of their wine. The municipal council takes a by-law so that the owners of the place, having vines on the neighbouring territories, do not carry out any mixing with "foreign fruit", which would tend to depreciate the quality of the wine and to deceive the good faith of the merchants.

Around 1870, Joseph DUCOS conducts intense research on the grape varieties. He determines the organoleptic contribution of each. The list of authorised varieties of the first decree of the controlled designation of origin, from which the one appearing in the specification derives, both for the production of red wines and of white wines, results from his works.

In 1923, the producers create, with Baron LE ROY de BOISEAUMARIE, the first union for the defence of the controlled designation of origin. They request and obtain, by the judgment of the Avignon court of 28 June 1929, a protective regulation representing the essential foundation of the controlled designation of origin (delimitation of the area, list of authorised varieties, minimum alcoholic strength by volume, sorting of the grapes, etc.), and of its first recognition decree of 15 May 1936. At the same period, these new requirements are taken up in the national regulation instituting the regime of the controlled designations of origin, thus giving the first example of a discipline and a policy subsequently adopted by the other French regions.

In 2010, the area of the vineyard extends over about 3,200 hectares, cultivated by 320 holdings. The average production is about 100,000 hectolitres, of which 95 % red wines.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The wines of the controlled designation of origin "Châteauneuf-du-Pape" are still and dry wines. The grapes, from a list of eighteen varieties, often co-planted within the same parcel, make it possible to elaborate white wines and red wines.

The grenache N variety is the dominant variety in the vineyard.

The red wines, particularly apt for keeping, are powerful and structured, with a great complexity and a long aromatic persistence.

The white wines, mainly elaborated from the grenache B, clairette B and roussanne B varieties, are ample, very expressive, with a good aromatic freshness.

3° – Causal interactions

Reflecting the usages, the delimited parcel area for the harvesting of the grapes retains the parcels presenting soils with numerous rolled pebbles mixed with a reddish clayey matrix of the famous Villafranchian terraces, and soils of sandy and sandstone texture. The interaction between the Mediterranean climate, hot and dry in summer, and these stony soils is at the origin of the phenomenon of the restitution, during the night, of the heat stored during the day by the rolled pebbles ("caïau frejaü"), thus favouring the complete ripeness and the concentration of the berries. Moreover, the dry climate, reinforced by the action of the Mistral, limits the development of cryptogamic diseases and favours the good sanitary condition of the harvest.

In these situations, the winegrowers' usages have led to a control of production reflected in low yields (35 hectolitres per hectare), while respecting the integrity of the potential of the raw material, notably by the prohibition of submersion, by the obligation of manual harvest and of sorting of the harvest, and by favouring concentration and ripeness. This know-how in the management of the vineyard goes hand in hand with the know-how of the producers, acquired over the generations, in mastering the varied soils and subsoils and the blending of varieties, with the objective of long vinifications, apt to reveal all the richness, the structure and the ageing aptitude of the wines — red, powerful and concentrated, and white, rich and complex.

Strong and proud of this history, the producers watch over the maintenance of the identity of their wines and, through it, over the maintenance of their own identity, of their heritage. The sale beyond the frontiers of the national territory and export, always in conquest of new countries, bear witness to this will of the producers and represent the major part of the production. Sale in bottle is very largely predominant.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Training methods

The provisions relating to planting density are applicable for the plantings carried out after 2 October 1992.

2° – Other cultivation practices

The provision relating to the prohibition of plastic mulching is applicable for the plantings carried out after 31 July 2009. The existing plastic mulches are removed from the parcels before 31 December 2014.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Châteauneuf-du-Pape" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that: - it is a registered cadastral lieu-dit; - it appears on the harvest declaration.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before the first bulk transaction, release for consumption or packaging, and at the latest on 31 December of the year of harvest. It indicates: - the designation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts, as well as a copy of the list of parcels presenting a rate of dead or missing vine plants greater than 15 %.

2. Declaration of bulk transaction or of bulk sale to the consumer and declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

For non-packaged wines, a transaction declaration, or a declaration of release for consumption, is sent to the approved control body at the latest fifteen days before the date of exit from the cellars. This declaration specifies, where applicable, whether the wine that is the subject of a bulk transaction is intended to be dispatched outside the national territory.

3. Prior declaration of packaging

A declaration prior to packaging, for wines ready to be packaged, is sent to the approved control body at the latest fifteen days before the scheduled date of packaging.

4. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of fifteen days after this downgrading.

5. Reworking of parcels

Before any addition of soil, any development or any works liable to modify the soil profile or the morphology of the relief (in particular if these works exceed 2 metres in cut or in fill) and with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, a declaration is sent by the operator to the defence and management body at least two months before the date scheduled for these works. The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

6. Prior declaration of non-vinification of the grapes arising from the qualitative sorting. "Râpé"

Every operator making the choice not to vinify the grapes arising from the qualitative sorting of the harvest makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body of the appellation at the latest seven days before the start of the harvest on its holding. A distinction by colour is possible. The defence and management body transmits this declaration as soon as possible to the approved control body.

II. – Keeping of registers

No specific provision.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary check (up-to-date CVI record)
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties, planting density)	Documentary check
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
Pruning rules, trellising	Check in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes	Self-checks and the setting up and dissemination, by the defence and management body, of a reference framework representative of the different zones of the controlled designation of origin
Sorting of the harvest	Check in the field
B3 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	- Documentary check (up-to-date keeping of the list) and check in the field; - Consistency of the harvest declaration
Authorised yield	Documentary check
Claim declaration	Documentary check and check in the field (compliance with the arrangements and deadlines, consistency with the harvest declaration, production declaration, etc.)
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
At the stage of the placing into circulation of the non-packaged products and at the packaging stage	Complete analytical examination of the wine
At the stage of the placing into circulation of the non-packaged products and/or at the packaging stage	Organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots

II. – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
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Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00
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The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, under the authority of the INAO, on the basis of an approved inspection plan.

The inspection plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. The whole of the checks is carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory are the subject of a systematic analytical and organoleptic check.